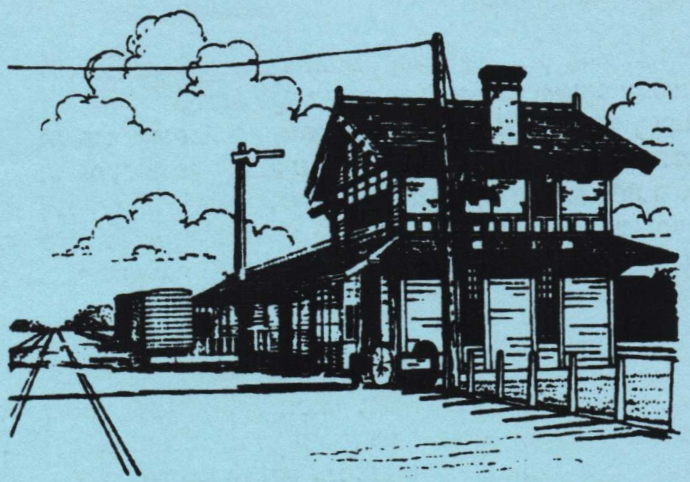
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1868

California's First Legislature
The February Meeting

Mary Jo Ignoffo is the author of a book, *Gold Rush Politics: California's First Legislature*, to be published in February. She will present a preview look at the men selected to the first American governing body in the state and what the legislators encountered when the arrived in the first state capital, San José, in December 1849.

Mary Jo Ignoffo is a former editor of *The Californian*, historian for the Sunnyvale *Orchard Heritage Park*, and author of *Sunnyvale: From the City of Destiny to the Heart of Silicon Valley*, published in 1994, and articles relating the history of our area and the state.

Ms. Ignoffo is currently authoring a book on the History of Mountain View, due for publication in 2001. It is planned to be available for distribution during 2002, the centennial year of the incorporation of the City of Mountain View.

Come meet the author and learn more about early California when the state capitol was in San José. As usual there will be the opportunity for light refreshments and fellowship after the presentation.

South Los Altos
The November Meeting

Beverly McChesney and Laura Cline are engaged in producing a history of South Los Altos. To this end they have produced two video tapes which are available for viewing in the History Center at the Mountain View Public Library. At the November 7, 1999 meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association they presented some of the material they have gathered. Of particular interest were the family trees of the Grant, Snyder, Dale and Bergin families, all of whom were prominent in early Mountain View. Their videos are filled with interesting photographs, maps and diagrams depicting the early days in the area. It's worth a trip to the History Center to view this material.

Program Suggestions

The objective of the Program Committee is to serve the membership of the Association. We would welcome any suggestions for appropriate topics for Association meetings. We have presented meetings dealing with the Indian and Spanish peoples of the area. We have had programs dealing with the agriculture and industry in the area. We have had programs dealing with historic buildings and artifacts around Mountain View. Perhaps its time to repeat some of these topics? There must be dozens of things related to the history of Mountain View, the Santa Clara Valley, the State of California that you would like to hear about. Give us your ideas. Talk to any of the

Association Officers at the next meeting, or drop us a line at:

Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Executive Committee Meeting

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met January 12, 2000.

Hilton Brown was appointed and confirmed as Treasurer for the term ending in November, 2000. Revisions in the recording and reporting of financial matters were discussed and the revised financial reports for the year ending December 31, 1999 were accepted. The changes and revisions are reflected in the Treasurer's Report, included in this Newsletter. You will also find a brief statement and explanation of the Association's financial position in this Newsletter.

The Membership Report is included elsewhere in this Newsletter. Several things should be noted in comparing the most current quarter with the previous quarter. Life Members have increased, entirely due to transfers from annual memberships. Total membership is down, at least partially due to late or deferred dues payments. Our President asked each member of the Executive Committee to try to bring in three new members. We encourage all of our members to bring a friend to our next meeting where they can make an informed decision to join the Association.

The next meetings of the Association will be Sunday, February 6, 2000; Sunday, May 7, 2000; the Annual Barbecue Sunday, August 6, 2000; and the Annual Meeting, Sunday, November 5, 2000.

Street Talk

Where is Eldora Drive, and for whom was it named?

Financial Position By Hilton Brown

The Mountain View Historical Association is in reasonable health, financially. The Treasurer's Report on page 7 of this Newsletter reflects our current situation. Our usual expenses are covered by membership dues and Life Memberships. The other things we do are financed thru donations and fund raising events.

We keep track of our commitments and financial condition thru a series of *Funds*. The *Adobe Fund* is committed to saving and enhancing the Adobe Building. The *Life Member Fund* is committed to servicing our Life Members. The *Memorial Fund* is dedicated to Memorializing Persons and events of Mountain View History. The *Operating Reserve Fund* is sufficient to carry on operations for two years if all sources of revenue should disappear. *Payables* at this time consists primarily of the balance owed for the *History of Mountain View*. This leaves *Unencumbered*, the amount we have not otherwise obligated. Note that this is a small negative number at this time, indicating that we have slightly greater obligations than resources. This is not a matter of current concern, as most of our obligations will not become due for many months or years.

My aim is full disclosure. I hope this new format of the quarterly financial report will make clear exactly where we stand.

Call For New Members

We would like to increase our membership. We hope that our quarterly meetings are worthwhile, and we believe that the fellowship at and after those meetings is satisfying and enjoyable. Bring a friend or acquaintance to the next meeting. We're sure that they will enjoy the meeting, and who knows, they might join the Association. No pressure. We think the Association serves a useful function, and we would like to reach as many people as possible.

Adobe Restoration

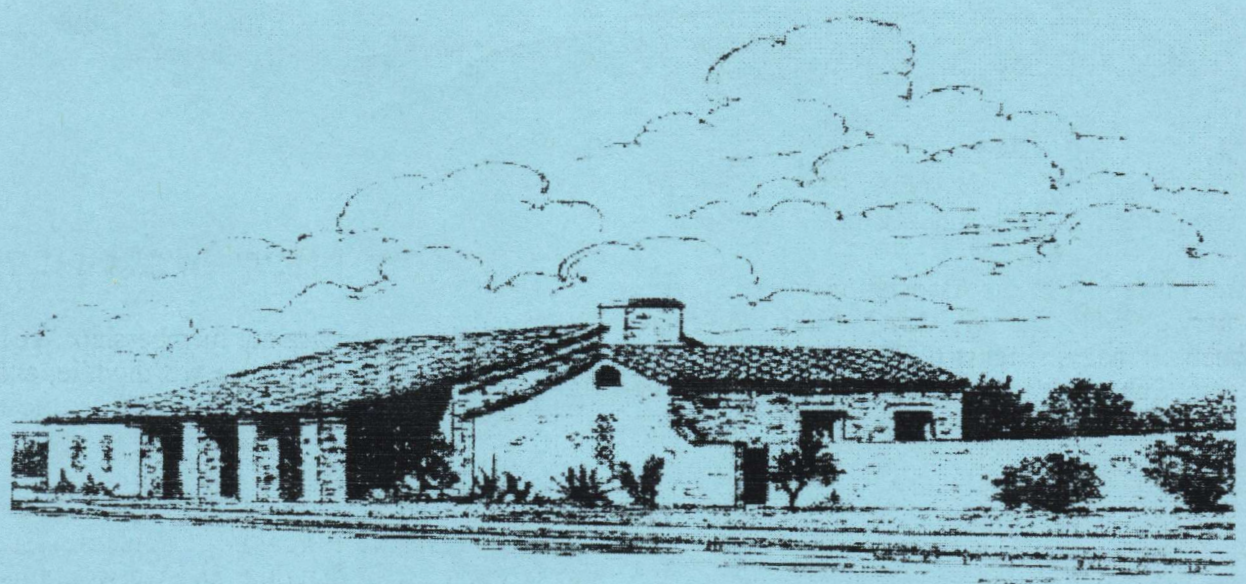
On January 11, 2000 the Mountain View City Council approved the plans and specifications for the Adobe Building Restoration and authorized staff to advertise for bids. The restoration will include structural and seismic improvements to bring the building into code compliance, concealed heating, ventilation, power and communications, renovated kitchen, and retrofitting of the fireplace. A perimeter wall, designed to appear as the original adobe wall will be built.

The architectural consultant has prepared documentation to upgrade the Adobe Building's historic designation and nominate it to the National Register of Historic Places.

If all goes according to plan, the City will award the construction contract in April, work will commence in May, and should be completed in January, 2001.

In Commemoration

Evelyn Emma Tucker Anderson: — Age 92, died November 3, 1999 at her Los Altos home. A native of South Dakota. A member of the Seventh Day Adventist Church, the Quadalco Club, and the Mountain View Historical Association. Mrs. Anderson was the buyer for the gift shop at El Camino Hospital for 13 years. She is survived by husband, Albert Anderson; son and daughter-in-law Richard and Clarice Anderson; grandchildren Patrice and Todd Anderson and great-grandchildren Tyler Anderson and Nathaniel Fratianni.



Old Newspaper Items Compiled by Barbara Kinchen

100 Years Ago (1900): Over 10,000 vines were pulled out at the Delmas vineyard on El Camino Real because they were affected "by a disease."

Good shooting now on the marshes - ducks, rail, doves and snipes. Ducks have swarmed into the sloughs and hunting clubs have leased all the choice locations in nearby fields.

Frogs for the San Francisco market are selling for $3.50 per dozen and several lowlanders are thinking of establishing ponds for the purpose of raising frogs. Recent rains have resulted in numerous frogs in lowland streams and two boys captured 15 dozen on Saturday.

Edward M. Ehrhorn, of Mountain View is the County Etymologist.

Only 9 out of 17 candidates taking test for teachers' certificates in Santa Clara County passed.

75 Years Ago (1925): "doctors declared a man who died in a Liethbridge, Canada hospital was literally talked to death by relatives who argued to induce him to change his will".

Paulding's store had a flannelette, stripes and plaids, for 16¢ a yard.

Fanucci & Sons, proprietors of the Castro Street Entrance Garage and Service Station received a franchise to operate a bus line between Mountain View and Oakland via Alviso and Milpitas. After the Dumbarton Bridge is completed, buses will return by way of Redwood City and Palo Alto.

Homeowners and councilmen were arguing over a method of financing the widening and paving of streets.

The Choral Society, under the direction of Neil Darrah, presented the Messiah in the auditorium at the high school.

The first milk pasteurizing plant in Mountain View was installed at Cost & Sons Dairy.

Moore Furniture Company, under the management of Charles H. Moore, has moved to 323 Castro, the former Soares Hotel building.

The Mountain View Register-Leader is delivered to more than 1,000 homes each week at $2.00 a year. Advertizing rates are 25¢ per inch.

Jenkins and Burwell's Taxi Service has headquarters at Randall's Candy Shop.

There are 535 telephones in the area served by Mountain View.

50 Years Ago (1950): Chamber of Commerce honors went to various members of the community: Mr. Mora Ames for work with Spanish-speaking residents; Mrs. Edna Roth, City Librarian, Earl Marler, manager of Ben Franklin Store; Jim Thomas, City Manager, who was designated Man-of-the-Year for 1949.

Pta presented the Life Membership Pin to Mrs. Lawrence Armanini for service to children and civic groups.

At El Camino Barbershop haircuts and saves were $1.00,

New businesses included: Al's Food Master (Al Rosingana) at View and Dana Streets; Middlefield Food Center at 2078 Middlefield Road by Perry and Bettencourt; B & H Rents on El Camino Real run by Brady and Holmes; Randall's Variety shop in Calderon Center at Church Street: "Farm Fresh No. 2' opened by John and Eddie Puppo on El Camino Real in Bill Garliepp's former location.

James Roosevelt, candidate for governor of California, spoke in front of City Hall to an audience of 175.

The Federal Public Housing Authority Project, 24 units on Central Avenue built in 1946, was turned over to the city.

Organized in Mountain View were Lions Club with a membership of 31 and a Business and Professional Woman's Club with Mrs. Mary Harris as president.

Mario Veglia bought the Paulding Building, corner of Castro and Dana Streets, occupied by J.C. Penney's before moving last year to the 200 block of Castro Street.

Students of Highway Grammar School can now safely cross under El Camino Real by using the completed underpass.

New to the Mountain View History Center by Barbara Kinchen

From Member Celestine "Sally" (Gemello) Traverso: Bottle of Obester 1977 Petite Sirah. Bottle was on the table at Sally's recent birthday celebration. Wine is from winery of Sandy Obester, Sally's daughter and the label is a drawing of John Gemello rolling a barrel of wine.

From Member Betty Monroe: Large framed oil painting, by Betty, of the 1888 train station.

From Beverly McChesney & Laura Cline: Video - 2nd part of Los Altos History. These two tapes contain the background material which Beverly and Laura presented to the Association on November 7, 1999.

From Larry Leib: Yardstick - Ad for Morton Furniture Store, 360 Castro Street.

From Member Mike Wester: Small advertising gadget from Wagner Rexall Drugs, 198 Castro Street, in the shape a metal frying pan with a thermometer.

Where It All Started Silicon Valley & The Barn

In 1947 William Shockley, John Bardeen and Walter Brattain developed the transistor, the basic device for the semiconductor industry. They were awarded the Nobel Prize in Physics for this work. In 1955 Shockley moved to Palo Alto and recruited a team of engineers and scientists to work for a new company, Shockley Semiconductor. Shockley opened his research and manufacturing facility in a building located at 391 San Antonio Road in Mountain View, adjacent to the San Antonio Mall. To those who worked there, the building was known as *"The Barn"*. Shockley's vision was of the commercial production of transistors. He recognized the technical superiority, for commercial purposes, of silicon as the semiconductor material for the fabrication of transistors.

One group of Shockley Semiconductor engineers left to form Fairchild Semiconductor, the birthplace of the integrated circuit. Nearly every semiconductor and integrated circuit company in the Bay area can likewise trace its origins to *The Barn* at 391 San Antonio.

William Shockley may not have been a very nice human being, but honoring William Shockley the man would not be the primary objective in memorializing *the barn*. Rather, it would be marking the location where a very significant turn in the direction of industrialized society took place.
There is a garage in Palo Alto that is properly regarded as a memorial to the beginnings of the modern commercial electronics industry. *The barn* is an equally important memorial to that other leg of modern technology, the commercial transistor. We should do everything we can to assist the City of Mountain View in recognizing this important historical site.

Rengstorff House



Old and Precious

This graceful old home now overlooks Shoreline Regional Park. It embodies a good deal of Mountain View's history, and it is very much too the credit of the community that they chose to preserve it. It provides an island of calm in our midst, and an opportunity to reflect upon just how we got here, and where we have been.

We are a multi-cultural society now, and in particular here where generations of peoples have come for the agricultural work, for the climate, for the high tech work. We are red, yellow, brown and white in our roots, and soon there will be no one race or nationality which constitutes a plurality.

If you haven't visited Rengstorff House you are missing out on some important insights in too who we are. It is indeed gratifying that the City of Mountain View is now proceeding with the renovation of the Adobe Building to add to our preserved heritage.

Membership Report by Edna Thompson

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	72
Special Member	1
Honored Member	1
Individual and Family Members	189
Total	263

New Life Members (Transfers)
- William Dale
- June Redwine de Larios
- Harry Pinto
- Ida Pinto
- Mary Lou Zoglin

Association Officers and Board Members

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Program	Wally Erichsen
Vice President	John Viscovich
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	Hilton Brown
Membership, Memorials And Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Newsletter	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Elizabeth Engberg Margaret Peterson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Life Members

As of December 31, 1999

Mario Ambra	Helen Shearer Krogh
Marge Hingsberger Bailey	June de Larios
Godfrey Baumgartner	Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Dena K. Bonnell	Madeline Chargon Malovos
Flora Brown	Frances Churin Mills
Hilton Brown	Eva Mockbee
Mary Ann Meek Buswell	Gail Urban Moore
Cliff Del Carlo	LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Alfred P. Chasuk	Mimi Mourkas
William A. Dale	Anne G. Nichols
Doris Ebere	Nancy Noe
Ruth Erichsen	Harry Pinto
Wallace Erichsen	Ida Pinto
Carmen Farvelli	Milan Popovich
Ralph Faravelli	John P. Puppo
Roger Fellows	Patricia J. Reyburn
Patricia Figueroa	Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Carole Fischer	Nancy L. Smith
Tom Frankum	Richard M. Smith
Marion Grimm	Martin J. Spangler
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger	Austin Spencer
Bill Henderson	Honor Spitz
Ed Henderson	J. R. Stafford
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson	Brigitte Stafford
Charles Hirschbek	H. Lee Stillens
Norene Hogle	Linda Swan
Alice D. Holden	Joseph Sweeney
George Holden	Roberta Sweeney
Donald M. Holt	Sally Moore Taboada
Virginia M. Holt	Edna Thompson
George Jagels	John Viscovich
Harold Jarvis	Arthur Walton
Al Jehning	Patricia Walton
R. Michael Kasperzak	Denise Williams
Robert W. Kirby	Bill Wissell
Joe Kleitman	Mary Lou Zoglin

Treasurer's Report By Hilton Brown

October 1, 1999 - December 31, 1999

Balance 1/10/99		$ 12,491.98
Income		
Annual Dues	614.00	
Life Members	700.00	
Special Events	450.00	
Sales	202.00	
Interest	13.25	
Donations	3.00	
Total Income		1,982.25
Expenses		
Business Expense	53.96	
Meeting Expense	7.25	
Membership Exp.	48.25	
Total Expenses		109.46
Balance 31/12/99		$ 14,364.77
Fund Balances		
Adobe Fund	$ 1,012.73	
Life Member Fund	6,385.00	
Memorial Fund	492.20	
Operating Reserve Fund	3,000.00	
Payables	3,656.25	
Unencumbered	(-181.41)	
Total Funds, Payables, Unencumbered		$ 14,364.77

Mountain View Historical Association

Regular Meeting

Sunday, February 6, 2000
2:00 PM
Senior Center - 266 Escuela

Topic and Speaker

California's First Legislature

Presented by
Mary Joe Ignoffo
Author, Editor, Historian

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____
Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

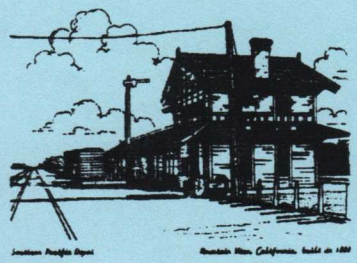
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